

MERSEYSIDE BMX CLUB

Bikes & Kit Guide

For new riders and parents — read before buying anything

Not sure where to start? Ask us first.

Before buying a bike speak to a coach or committee member. We can check your rider's measurements and recommend the right size. Contact us at merseysidebmx@gmail.com or speak to a coach at any session.

1. ESSENTIAL KIT

REQUIRED	Full Face Helmet BMX or MTB specific. Not motocross. Buy from a proper bike shop, not a toy shop.
REQUIRED	Gloves Full finger gloves. Mandatory at all sessions.
REQUIRED	Long sleeves and trousers Required at all sessions. No shorts without knee and shin pads.
RECOMMENDED	Body Armour Upper body covering torso and arms. Strongly recommended once committed.
RECOMMENDED	Knee and Shin Pads Required with shorts. Advisable with race pants too.

Hire available at the club: Bike, helmet, pads and gloves for **£3 per session**. Tuesday and Thursday only. Limited availability.

2. HELMETS

Always try before buying. The helmet must fit snug on the cheeks and top of the head with no movement.

Brand	Price	Notes
7Protection M1	~£70	Good starter option. Youth M to Adult XL.
Bell	~£70	Well known, widely available.
Leatt	~£100	Good mid range option.
100%	~£100	Popular in the BMX community.
Fox	~£150	Wide range of sizes.
Fly Racing	~£200	Premium option.
Troy Lee Designs	£250+	Top of the range.

3. BODY PROTECTION

Full Body Armour

Covers torso and arms in one piece. Best option once committed. More expensive but comprehensive protection.

Elbow and Arm Pads

More affordable option for new riders. Covers key injury points. Good starting choice.

Brands: Fox, Raceface, 7Protection, 100%, S1, Leatt, G-Form, Troy Lee Designs

4. BIKE SIZES

Size depends on the rider's height and inside leg measurement. Always follow the manufacturer's size guide for the specific brand you are buying.

Size	Wheels	Tyres
Micro	18"	Skinny
Micro Mini	20"	Skinny
Mini	20"	Skinny
Junior	20"	Skinny
Expert	20"	Skinny
Expert XL	20"	Skinny
Pro L	20"	Thicker
Pro XL	20"	Thicker
Pro XXL	20"	Thicker
Pro XXXL	20"	Thicker

Important: Do not size up for a rider to grow into. This can hinder progress. Speak to us if you are between sizes.

5. FACTORY COMPLETE vs CUSTOM BUILD

Factory Complete — FOR NEW RIDERS

Best and most cost effective choice. Comes fully assembled, ready to ride. Typically £400 to £700 new.

Custom Build — NOT FOR BEGINNERS

Starts at £1,500+. Not recommended until fully committed. A custom build will not make a rider faster on its own.

6. RECOMMENDED STARTER BRANDS

StayStrong	Meybo	Haro	Radio
Inspyre	Jet BMX	Cuda	GT (second hand)

GT are currently on brand pause but widely available second hand, especially Speed Series models.

7. PRICE GUIDE

£100–£300 SECOND HAND Good starter option. Make sure it is a race bike.	£200–£400 IDEAL BUDGET Sweet spot for a good second hand or entry level new bike.	£400–£700+ BRAND NEW New complete bike from a shop. Good once committed.
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8. WHERE TO BUY

DC Cycles CLUB SPONSOR	dccycles.co.uk	Club sponsor — please support them
Alan's BMX	alansbmx.com	Wigan — within 30 mins of Liverpool
Winstanleys BMX	winstanleysbmx.com	Wigan — within 30 mins of Liverpool
Sorted Racegear	sortedracegear.com	Warrington — within 30 mins
Crucial BMX	crucialbmxshop.com	Bristol — ships UK wide
Source BMX	sourcebmx.com	Online only

Second hand tip: Many BMX bikes listed online are park or street bikes, not race bikes. Do not send money upfront for a bike you are not sure about. Ask the club before buying.

Merseyside BMX Club Knowsley Leisure and Culture Park, Longview Drive, Huyton, L36 6EG merseysidebmx@gmail.com	Full guide at merseysidebmx.co.uk	You do not need a high end bike to begin. Focus on confidence, skills and technique first.
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